Message

ONE OF THE OBJECTIVES OF The A.D. Shroff Memorial Trust is to encourage the writing of biographies of individuals who have contributed significantly to the building of the Indian economy. The Trust has published a few such biographies in the past which have been well-received. However, since the Trust had not been associated with the publication of an authoritative study on banking it decided to invite Bakhtiar K. Dadabhoy to write this book. This book highlights the outstanding contributions of six stalwarts who played a pioneering role in shaping the course of Indian banking. The six pioneers, whose contributions are narrated through the history of five seminal banking institutions, played a central role not only in the growth and development of institutions which they conceived, founded or led, but left their impress on the banking industry as a whole.

What is significant is that all of them had the vision to look beyond their immediate horizon. Their sights were set high; their gaze often distant. They had the conviction to swim against the tide and during several critical periods of the last century they often ploughed a lonely furrow, while displaying rare courage and vision. Above all, they were men of great integrity whose principles and values were an inspiration to their peers and will continue to serve as a beacon for future generations as well.

Books on banking often suffer from a lack of reader interest but Bakhtiar has successfully avoided this pitfall. Not only has he produced a highly readable account which arouses and maintains the readers interest in what might have been a dull subject in less skilful hands, he also discusses